

11. Uninterruptible Power Supply

Unless you have a UPS, this service is a resource hog.

12. Terminal Services

Unless you plan on using the Remote Desktop feature and other remote management tools, disable this service.

13. Wireless Zero Configuration

Unless you have a wireless device that needs auto-configuration (lame), you can disable this service.

14. Themes

This service gives Windows XP its slick user interface. Disabling it will make your system respond faster, but Windows won't nearly look so good after you do that! Try disabling the service and see if you can live with the effect it has. You can re-enable it if you don't like what you see.

15. Smart Card

This service does nothing but enable use of smart card authentication in Windows XP.

8.4 The Windows Registry

If you want to really tweak Windows, you'll need to fiddle around with the registry. The registry is complex, and its health is crucial for the proper functioning of Windows. As we've said time and again, don't mess with it without knowing what you're doing! But since you'd like to know the basics of the Registry, we try and demystify it here, while mentioning some basic hacks.

8.4.1 What The Registry Is

As you know, the OS is a huge, complex piece of code that acts as a bridge between the user and the hardware. During its operations on various data, the OS requires lot of information (variables). For